

Smoking

1/- Causes of smoking :

Smoking is caused by a mixture of social pressure, emotional struggles, and environmental influence. One of the main causes is peer pressure, as many teenagers start smoking in order to fit in and feel accepted within a group. In addition, parental influence plays a major role, especially when children grow up seeing their parents smoke, which normalizes the habit from an early age. In school environments, some students also begin smoking to appear more mature or “cool” in front of others. Another important factor is stress and emotional pressure, as individuals may turn to smoking as a temporary escape from anxiety, academic pressure, or personal problems. Furthermore, lack of awareness about the long-term dangers of smoking, combined with curiosity and media influence, can push people especially teenagers towards trying cigarettes without fully understanding the consequences.

2/- Effects of smoking :

a/- Effects on health :

Effects of smoking on health: Smoking has extremely harmful effects on human health, many of which are life-threatening. It can cause serious diseases such as lung cancer and throat cancer, and it significantly increases the risk of heart attacks and strokes due to nicotine, which raises heart rate and damages blood vessels. Smokers are also more likely to suffer from respiratory diseases such as asthma, chronic bronchitis, and other breathing disorders linked to high blood pressure and lung damage. Over time, smoking weakens the respiratory system, making individuals short of breath and reducing their ability to perform physical activities such as walking long distances or playing sports. In severe cases, long-term smoking can lead to premature death and irreversible damage to vital organs.

b/- Effects on looks :

Smoking also has visible effects on physical appearance. It causes yellow and stained teeth, persistent bad breath, premature wrinkles, and dull skin, making a person look older than their actual age.

c/- Effects on environment :

From an environmental perspective, smoking contributes to air pollution, as every cigarette releases toxic chemicals into the atmosphere. These

pollutants not only contaminate the air but also expose non-smokers to passive smoking, which can be equally dangerous. Environmentally, cigarette waste such as filters also adds to land pollution when improperly discarded.

c/- Effects on budget :

Financially, smoking is a costly habit, as cigarette prices continue to rise and daily consumption quickly accumulates into a heavy long-term expense that damages personal savings and financial stability.

3/- How to stop smoking :

Stopping smoking requires determination, awareness, and strong support systems. One effective method is adopting the right psychological approach, where smokers are guided rather than blamed, helping them gradually overcome addiction. Participation in anti-smoking campaigns is also essential, as it raises awareness about the dangers of smoking and encourages individuals to quit through education and support. Replacing smoking with healthier habits such as sports, hobbies, or relaxation techniques can help reduce cravings and stress triggers. In addition, stricter laws such as banning smoking in public areas can reduce exposure and discourage the habit in society. Nicotine replacement therapies and medical support can also assist addicted smokers in managing withdrawal symptoms. Finally, encouragement from family and friends plays a crucial role in helping individuals stay motivated and permanently quit smoking.